of plants and 91,000 species of animals. The country's diverse physical features and climatic conditions have resulted in a variety of ecosystems such as forests, wetlands, grasslands, desert, coastal and marine ecosystems. Four of 34 globally identified biodiversity hotspots are found in India. They are:

- The Himalayas
- The Western ghats
- The North-East
- The Nicobar islands

India became state member of IUCN in 1969, through the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate change(MoEFCC).

DO YOU KNOW?

IUCN was founded on 5th October 1948 at Gland, Switzerland.



CR: Himalayan brown/red bear



EN: Red Panda

Figure 24.9 Animals in Red List

Points to Remember

- Cyclic flow of nutrients between non-living environment and living organisms are termed as biogeochemical cycles.
- The ammonium compounds formed by ammonification process is oxidised to soluble nitrates. The process of nitrate formation is known as nitrification.
- Hydrophytes may be free floating or submerged plants living in lakes, ponds, shallow water, marshy lands and marine habitat.
- Plants that grow in dry habitat are called xerophytes.
- Mesophytes are common land plants which grow in situations that are neither too wet nor too dry.
- Animals develop special features or behaviour patterns to escape from the extreme conditions of temperature and light.
- Farm pond is a dugout structure with definite shape and size for collecting the surface runoff flowing from the area around the farm.
- Water recycling is reusing treated wastewater for beneficial purposes
- IUCN is the global authority on the status of the natural world and the measures needed to safeguard it.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Aestivation	State of inactivity and a lowered metabolic rate in animals, during summer.
Assimilation	Conversion of nutrients into usable form that is incorporated into the tissues and organs.
Buoyancy	Capacity to remain afloat in liquid or gas.
Echo location	Use of sound waves and their echoes to determine the location of objects.
Hibernation	State of inactivity and a lowered metabolic rate in animals, during winter.
Infiltration	Process by which water on the ground surface enters the soil.
Precipitation	Product of condensation of atmospheric water vapour that falls on earth.
Setae	Hair-like locomotory structure, present in each segment of an earthworm.
Stomata	Minute pores in the epidermis of leaves which facilitate gaseous exchange and transpiration.
Sublimation	Conversion of solid state into vapour state without going through a liquid state.

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